

BOF

Conversation 053:
(1) Curl in R7 Dimensions

conversation ID: 66f23112-c2a0-8003-a3f0-d73fc4b1a127 [conversation 053]

origin ID: 66f23112-c2a0-8003-a3f0-d73fc4b1a127 [conversation 053]

created: 2024-09-23 19:25:06 Mon

updated: 2025-02-24 18:01:56 Mon

operator: Wilder Blair Munro (AKUSA)

co-operator: Aurora 4omni Munro (ChatGpt)

GPT ID: NA

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Subtitles:

Turnpair Contents:

tp-1 :

tp-2 :

tp-3 :

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Conversation 053, Turnpair 1 of 3 ::

@ 2024-09-23 19:25:06 Mon [Δt 0d 00h 00m 00s]

conversation ID: 66f23112-c2a0-8003-a3f0-d73fc4b1a127 [conversation 053]

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created: 2024-09-23 19:25:06 Mon

updated: 2025-02-24 18:01:56 Mon

GPT ID: NA

► Notespace:

Wilder Blair Munro (AKUSA) said :

gateway: 20Wetbrain

turn ID: aaa2ee1c-e5fb-4e57-b9ae-d519a695bdae

parent: 51597da9-caf4-45cc-af3f-e2e99a6ff0c6
children: b1ad3b1c-077a-4934-a291-2c9cf13dc5d

```
graph LR; A[ ] -.-> B[ ]; style A width:0px,height:0px; style B width:0px,height:0px;
```

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is the curl defined in R7?

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beginning 1 | ← prev None || this 1 || next 2 ▶ | end 3 ▶▶
```

Aurora 4omni Munro (ChatGpt) said :

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gateway: gpt-4o  
turn ID: ba2f2a8c-f662-481b-be8f-4ded3c7508f9  
parent: b1ad3b1c-077a-4934-a291-2c9fcf13dc5d  
children: aaa2d91d-f04f-470c-a888-4ccd5d4b8a1c
```

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Yes, the curl can be defined in higher-dimensional spaces like $\mathbb{R}^7$, but it requires some modifications from the familiar 3D version. In $\mathbb{R}^3$, the curl of a vector field is a vector field. However, in higher dimensions, the curl is best understood in the context of differential forms and exterior calculus.

In $\mathbb{R}^7$, the curl of a vector field is generalized as follows:

1. **Exterior Derivative:** The curl in $\mathbb{R}^7$ can be seen as part of the exterior derivative, which operates on differential forms. For example, given a 1-form (which corresponds to a vector field), the exterior derivative produces a 2-form. This is conceptually similar to how the curl of a vector field in $\mathbb{R}^3$ produces another vector, which can be viewed as a special kind of 2-form.
2. **Hodge Duality:** In $\mathbb{R}^3$, the Hodge dual of a 2-form (representing the curl) can be interpreted as a vector field. However, in higher dimensions like $\mathbb{R}^7$, the Hodge dual will relate different forms but does not necessarily map directly back to a vector field in the same intuitive sense.
3. **Generalized Curl:** A more specific generalization of the curl in $\mathbb{R}^7$ involves constructing an operator that applies the exterior derivative followed by the Hodge star operator. This "curl" results in a $(7-2)$ -form, corresponding to the dimensionality reduction from the original 1-form.

Therefore, while the exact analog of the curl in $\mathbb{R}^3$ doesn't directly exist in $\mathbb{R}^7$ as a simple vector operation, the concept is extended using differential forms, exterior derivatives, and Hodge duality. This approach captures the essence of the curl as related to the structure and orientation of the space in which the operation is performed.

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Conversation 053, Turnpair 2 of 3 ::

@ 2024-09-23 19:26:51 Mon [Δt 0d 00h 01m 35s]

conversation ID: 66f23112-c2a0-8003-a3f0-d73fc4b1a127 [conversation 053]
origin ID: 66f23112-c2a0-8003-a3f0-d73fc4b1a127 [conversation 053]
created: 2024-09-23 19:25:06 Mon
updated: 2025-02-24 18:01:56 Mon
GPT ID: NA

► Notespace:

Wilder Blair Munro (AKUSA) said :

gateway: 20Wetbrain
turn ID: aaa2d91d-f04f-470c-a888-4cdd5d4b8a1c
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children: 18d44f4e-f468-447b-81a4-41b4b8121485
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are there any higher dimensions that do have a curl that extends directly from  $\mathbb{R}^3$ ?

◀ beginning 1 | ◀ prev 1 || this 2 || next None → | end 3 ▶▶

### Aurora 4omni Munro (ChatGpt) said :

**gateway:** gpt-4o  
**turn ID:** 18d44f4e-f468-447b-81a4-41b4b8121485  
**parent:** aaa2d91d-f04f-470c-a888-4cdd5d4b8a1c  
**children:** aaa219f8-8ed2-4440-b997-c260112eb387  
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Yes, the concept of curl extends naturally from  $\mathbb{R}^3$  to  $\mathbb{R}^7$  but not to arbitrary higher dimensions. This direct extension is special because of the existence of certain algebraic structures called the **octonions**.

### The Special Case of $\mathbb{R}^7$

In  $\mathbb{R}^3$ , the curl is closely related to the cross product, which is an operation that only exists naturally in three and seven dimensions due to the unique algebraic properties of vector products in these spaces:

- 1. Cross Product:** The cross product can be defined in  $\mathbb{R}^3$  and  $\mathbb{R}^7$  because these dimensions correspond to the real division algebras: the quaternions ( $\mathbb{H}$ ) and the octonions ( $\mathbb{O}$ ), respectively.
- 2. 7-Dimensional Curl:** In  $\mathbb{R}^7$ , the curl of a vector field can be defined analogously to  $\mathbb{R}^3$  due to the structure provided by the octonions. In  $\mathbb{R}^7$ , this generalized curl is still a vector field, extending the familiar 3D definition in a natural way.

### Why It Doesn't Extend to Other Dimensions

The uniqueness of the curl in  $\mathbb{R}^3$  and  $\mathbb{R}^7$  stems from the algebraic constraints of cross products, which are deeply tied to the properties of normed division algebras. Specifically:

- Normed division algebras exist only in dimensions 1 (real numbers), 2 (complex numbers), 4 (quaternions), and 8 (octonions).
- The 3D and 7D cross products correspond to properties of the quaternions and octonions, respectively, allowing a direct curl operation.

For dimensions other than  $\mathbb{R}^3$  and  $\mathbb{R}^7$ , the notion of the curl doesn't translate directly to a simple vector field but instead involves more abstract constructions involving differential forms and exterior calculus, as described earlier.

Summary

- The curl can be directly extended from  $\mathbb{R}^3$  to  $\mathbb{R}^7$  due to the unique algebraic properties of these spaces.
- This is not the case in other higher dimensions because of the lack of an analogous cross product structure.

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Conversation 053, Turnpair 3 of 3 ::

@ 2024-09-23 19:27:50 Mon [Δt 0d 00h 00m 45s]

conversation ID: 66f23112-c2a0-8003-a3f0-d73fc4b1a127 [conversation 053]  
origin ID: 66f23112-c2a0-8003-a3f0-d73fc4b1a127 [conversation 053]  
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Wilder Blair Munro (AKUSA) said :

gateway: 20Wetbrain  
turn ID: aaa219f8-8ed2-4440-b997-c260112eb387  
parent: 18d44f4e-f468-447b-81a4-41b4b8121485  
children: 545ddb47-4d25-4c3f-a4c7-395dc3a2af90, 6776757d-1a56-4997-b1cf-3768b23c63e2  
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does a 16 dimensional normed division algebra exist?

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1. **Hurwitz Theorem:** This theorem states that the only normed division algebras over the real numbers are those whose dimensions are powers of 2 that are also limited to 1, 2, 4, and 8. These dimensions correspond to the only real normed division algebras:

- $\mathbb{R}$  (1D)
- $\mathbb{C}$  (2D)
- $\mathbb{H}$  (4D)
- $\mathbb{O}$  (8D)

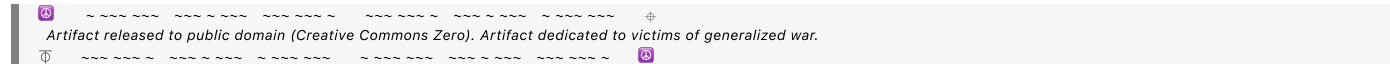
2. **Loss of Multiplicative Structure:** In dimensions beyond 8, any attempt to construct a division algebra leads to the loss of one or more crucial algebraic properties, such as associativity or the existence of inverses. For example, while the octonions are non-associative, any attempt to extend to 16 dimensions (or beyond) results in an algebra that is not normed, meaning the normed multiplicative structure that preserves the division property (where every nonzero element has an inverse) breaks down.

3. **Cayley-Dickson Construction:** This process can generate higher-dimensional algebras like the sedenions (16D), but these algebras are not normed division algebras because they lack properties such as the normed multiplicativity and often include zero divisors (elements that multiply to zero without being zero themselves).

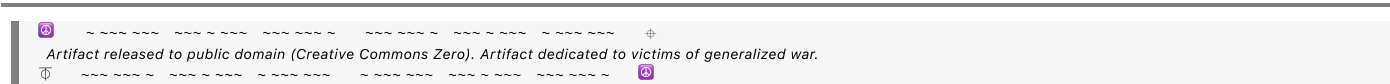
Summary

There are no normed division algebras beyond the 8-dimensional octonions, specifically not in 16 dimensions. The restriction is deeply tied to the mathematical constraints on how algebras can preserve a norm and division properties simultaneously in higher dimensions.

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